Another potential reason for the difference in HTTP libraries is that there hasn't been a pure-Elixir HTTP client until recently. All of the previous clients were based on Erlang foundations. Mint, Finch, and Req are all pure-Elixir libraries, so the chance of these sticking as the go-to libraries is higher than if they were Erlang-based.

Next, let's talk about why we'll use Req in this book.

The Decision

We have only three real choices: HTTPoison, Req, or Tesla. The other choices are too low-level or aren't friendly enough for us to even consider.

We'll immediately remove HTTPoison from consideration because it's based on dated foundations when compared to Req or Tesla. However, HTTPoison is still used by many apps and is actually not a bad client.

Let's consider Tesla next. This book was originally written to use Tesla, but it was changed because Req appears to be the future of Elixir HTTP clients. Tesla and Req both use Finch as their default HTTP adapter, so it's only a matter of preference.

Req is relatively new when compared to Tesla, but it has more approval in the ecosystem and provides all of the features we need. It works securely out of the box, is easy to use, allows for creating client libraries, and supports a rich set of HTTP features. It's a great fit for this book, so we'll use it.

Now, let's set up and then use Req!

Prep Your Project for Req

We'll start off by setting up Req and the application configuration that we'll use throughout this section. Then, in the next section, we'll write our HTTP client and connect it to our existing app.

Let's make sure that your project is prepared for this chapter. We'll use a provided helper app called `mock_server` that implements a Twilio-compatible SMS API, so you need to have this downloaded to your local computer if you want to see it in action.

Prep Your Project

We'll continue the project that you developed in the previous chapter. It's best to continue your own project from start to finish, but you can start with a clean version of the code by working out of the `phone_app_end_7` directory provided in the book source code.